Ning Jia

Fifth-year Ph.D. Student in Economics

Department of Spatial Economics, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam

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De Boelelaan 1105, 1081 HV Amsterdam, The Netherlands

Supervisors: Jan Rouwendal, Florian Sniekers, Hans R.A. Koster

Research Interests: Urban and Real Estate Economics; Search and Matching; Macroprudential Policy

EDUCATION

Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, Netherlands 09/2022 - 06/2027 (expected)

Ph.D. student in Economics

Shanghai Jiao Tong University, China 09/2018 - 03/2022

Master of Economics

Nanjing University of Aeronautics and Astronautics, China 09/2014 - 06/2018

Bachelor of Energy and Power Engineering

JOB MARKET PAPER

Option Loss and Transaction Cascades in the Housing Market *(with Ruiyu Zhu)*

Abstract: In booming housing markets, transactions may generate their own momentum as property sales create urgency among other buyers. We develop a dynamic sequential-search model in which property sales signal tighter market conditions and generate transaction cascades. Using data from a major Chinese housing platform, we exploit the quasi-random timing of sales of previously visited properties to identify option-loss shocks. Option loss increases buyers' purchase probability by 67%, whereas sales of similar but unvisited properties have little effect, highlighting the importance of inclusion in the buyer's choice set. The effect is stronger in tighter markets and among buyers with larger choice sets, and a back-of-the-envelope calculation suggests that these cascades account for about 30% of market-level transaction activity. Option loss also reduces subsequent search and is associated with higher transaction prices.

Presentations: 2nd Zurich–Oxford Doctoral Symposium on Real Estate Markets; Tinbergen Institute PhD Seminar; SMU–Jinan Conference on Urban and Regional Economics 2026 *(scheduled)*; European Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society 2026 *(scheduled)*.

WORKING PAPERS

Borrowing Constraints and the Rise of the Private Rental Sector *(with Jan Rouwendal and Florian Sniekers)*

Presentations: UEA North American 2021; UEA European 2023; EEA–ESEM 2023; IAAE 2024; ECHOPPE 2024; AREUEA International 2024; Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco 2024; ReCapNet 2024; Zurich–Bern Workshop 2025; ESWC 2025; AREUEA–ASSA 2026.

New Listings and Housing Market Congestion *(Single Author)*

Presentations: UEA European 2025; AREUEA International 2025.

List Prices in Segmented Housing Markets *(with Jan Rouwendal and Florian Sniekers)*

Presentations: UEA North American 2024; 2nd Chinese Summer Meeting in Urban Economics 2024; BVRN Workshop 2025; UEA European 2026; EEA–ESEM 2026; De Nederlandse Economendag 2026 *(scheduled)*; AREUEA–ASSA 2027 *(scheduled)*.

Initial Public Offerings and Local Entrepreneurship: Evidence from China *(With Ge Yang)*

WORK IN PROGRESS

Place-based Policy, Housing Supply, and House Prices: Evidence from New Town Construction in Shanghai

Decomposing the Effects of Job Displacement: Evidence from Netherlands

PRE-DOC PUBLICATION

- **Ning Jia**, Huiyong Zhong. 2021. The Causes and Consequences of China's Municipal Amalgamations: Evidence from Population Redistribution. China & World Economy, 30: 174-200.

PRESENTATIONS

- 2027: AREUEA-ASSA Conference Washington D.C. 2027 (planned).
- 2026: AREUEA-ASSA Conference Philadelphia; UEA European Meeting Barcelona*; EEA-ESEM Dublin; Zurich–Oxford Doctoral Symposium Oxford; 2026 European Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society (planned), 2026 SMU-Jinan Conference on Urban and Regional Economics (planned).
- 2025: UEA European Meeting Berlin; BVRN Workshop Amsterdam; AREUEA International Conference Barcelona; Zurich-Bern Real Estate Finance and Economics Workshop Zurich; Econometric Society World Congress Seoul.
- 2024: UEA North American Meeting Washington D.C.; UEA Summer School Geneva; IAAE Annual Conference Xiamen; RecapNet Conference Stockholm; Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco*.
- 2021: CEA Forum (Online); CCER SI Beijing, Seminar CUFE Beijing

Notes:* denotes presenting by co-authors.

HONORS & PRIZES

- First-class Scholarship for Graduate Students, Shanghai Jiao Tong University.

- Outstanding Paper Award of the 4th Public Administration Forum in Tsinghua University.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- **Teaching Assistant at Shanghai Jiao Tong University**
  - Chinese Economy, MBA — Spring, 2019
  - Macroeconomic Analysis of China, MBA — Fall, 2019
- **Teaching Assistant at VU Amsterdam**
  - Real Estate Economics, Master — Fall, 2025
  - Housing Economics and Finance, Master — Spring, 2027
  - Real Estate Finance and Investment, Master — Spring, 2026
- **Student Supervision at VU Amsterdam**
  - Bachelor thesis. — Spring, 2026

OTHER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- Research Assistant for Ming Lu, SJTU — 2018-2020
- Research Assistant for Hans R.A. Koster, VU Amsterdam — 2025-2026

CERTIFICATES & SKILLS

- **Computer Skills**: STATA, ArcGIS, Python, Matlab, LaTeX
- **Languages**: Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)